LEGAL DESCRIPTIONS · 1

Metes and Bounds

ANSWER · 1

A legal description using compass directions and distances from a defined point of beginning, tracing the boundary until it closes back on itself. Common for irregular parcels.

LEGAL DESCRIPTIONS · 2

Section, Township, and Range

ANSWER · 2

The rectangular government survey system dividing land into 6-mile-square townships, each split into 36 one-mile-square sections (640 acres each) — used to describe unplatted rural land.

LEGAL DESCRIPTIONS · 3

Lot and Block

ANSWER · 3

A legal description that refers to a recorded subdivision plat by lot number, block number, and the plat's filing information — used for platted (subdivided) property.

LEGAL DESCRIPTIONS · 4

Platted vs. Unplatted Land

ANSWER · 4

Platted land has been formally subdivided and recorded on a plat map (described by lot and block). Unplatted land has not, and is typically described by metes and bounds or section/township/range.

LEGAL DESCRIPTIONS · 5

Point of Beginning (POB)

ANSWER · 5

The fixed starting/ending point in a metes and bounds description. The description must return to this exact point for the description to "close."

LEGAL DESCRIPTIONS · 6

Essential Elements of a Good Legal Description

ANSWER · 6

Concise and clear, with a locatable point of beginning and definite tie-points, so the parcel it describes can be found and distinguished from every other parcel.

LEGAL DESCRIPTIONS · 7

"Lots 1 to 6 inclusive"

ANSWER · 7

"Inclusive" means both endpoints are included — so "Lots 1 to 6 inclusive" means Lots 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, AND 6 (six lots total), not five.

LEGAL DESCRIPTIONS · 8

Describing a Lot Plus Part of Another

ANSWER · 8

When combining an entire lot with only part of another (e.g., the N½ of Lot 3 and all of Lot 4), each portion must be described separately and precisely — a vague combined reference like "the N½ of Lots 3 and 4" is wrong and ambiguous.

LEGAL DESCRIPTIONS · 9 EXAM-STYLE

A standard township contains how many sections?

ANSWER · 9

36

6 × 6 = 36 sections.

General real-property knowledge rather than a Colorado-specific rule. Section, township, and range is a core legal-description method.

LEGAL DESCRIPTIONS · 10 EXAM-STYLE

A lot-and-block legal description is based on or found in a:

ANSWER · 10

Recorded subdivision plat

Lot + Block = PLAT.

Lot and block is one of the main legal-description methods, along with section-township-range and metes and bounds.

LEGAL DESCRIPTIONS · 11 EXAM-STYLE

"Lots 1 through 6" in a legal description refers to:

ANSWER · 11

Parcels in a recorded subdivision plat

LOT numbers ⇒ a recorded PLAT ⇒ subdivision parcels. "Unplatted" can never have lots. Also remember "Lots 1 to 6 inclusive" = six lots, not five.

Lot-and-block is one of the three main legal-description methods, alongside metes and bounds and section-township-range.

YOUR OWN CARD

ANSWER